BRIEF · OCTOBER 2026

A Verification Layer for AI Agents

Every sentence an AI system writes, checked against the documents behind it before anyone outside sees it. Built and run in production in a newsroom; designed for any business that lets AI speak for it.

98.8%	2.3%	15	1 call
of planted factual errors caught (476 of 482)	of all sentences blocked although correct (68 of 2,934)	source languages besides English, with no measurable loss of accuracy	to the language model per three to four sentences checked

Twelve pre-registered test rounds on 120 held-out news articles, October 2026. The paper gives every figure with its 95% interval.

1 The problem: agents state company facts no document supports

Companies are putting AI agents in front of customers and into daily decisions. Forty percent of respondents at organizations with more than $1 billion in revenue report scaling AI agents, up from 27% a year earlier.[1] Gartner expects a third of enterprise software applications to include agentic AI by 2028, and more than 40% of agentic AI projects to be canceled by the end of 2027 for escalating costs, unclear business value or inadequate risk controls.[2] The risk is concrete:

Air Canada 2024	The website chatbot told a customer that a bereavement fare could be claimed retroactively, which the airline did not allow. The tribunal held the airline responsible: it "did not take reasonable care to ensure its chatbot was accurate."[3]
Cursor 2025	An AI support agent told a user that a subscription allowed one device "as a core security feature." The company had no such policy.[4]
Deloitte Australia 2025	A government report written with a language model contained a fabricated quote from a court judgment and references to research papers that do not exist. Deloitte agreed to repay the final instalment of the contract.[5]

In each case the company held the documents that settled the question. Nothing checked the agent's words against them before they went out.

2 What exists: a fact-check desk in production

Bushwick Daily, a New York City news publisher, drafts articles with language models. Since October 2026 no machine-drafted article can be published until it has passed a fact-check desk. The desk holds every document the article was written from and checks each sentence against them:

- **Code first.** Code settles every sentence it can decide with certainty: a quotation no document contains, a figure no document holds, a passage that states the whole sentence. A language model reads only the remaining sentences, and only the passages code located for them.
- **Every claim traced.** Each excerpt the model cites is verified word for word against the document it names. Each decision is stored with the passages behind it and can be replayed.
- **Fail-closed.** A sentence the documents do not support blocks publication until an editor resolves it. After the model reads, code checks dates, date ranges, durations and who-reported-what again.
- **Any language.** Sources in Spanish, Chinese, Urdu, Polish, Korean and ten other languages are read by meaning with a model that runs on the company's own machine.

It was tested the hard way. Before each round, the protocol, the articles and the pass criteria were committed in writing; an agent that never saw the desk planted forty errors into real sentences; and agents that never saw its verdicts labelled every sentence. Twelve such rounds stopped 476 of 482 planted errors. The cost is controlled by design: in the latest rounds code settled 23 to 31 sentences per round with no model call, and a re-check of an unchanged text replays stored readings instead of buying them again.

3 Where it fits in an agentic system

COMPANY DOCUMENTS	AGENT DRAFTS	VERIFICATION LAYER	OUT THE DOOR
Policies, price lists, contracts, filings, procedures	A reply, quote, summary or report	Each sentence checked against the documents; unsupported ones blocked, with the reason	Only what the documents support

A company's own documents are a closed set of evidence, like a newsroom's folder. The layer sits between the agent and the outside world:

- **Customer service:** refund, fare, warranty and eligibility answers checked against the policy that governs them.
- **Sales and proposals:** prices, terms and product claims checked against the price list and the contract.
- **Finance and investor relations:** figures, periods and attributions in summaries and notes checked against the filings they restate.
- **Legal and compliance:** quotations and cited provisions checked word for word against the authorities held.
- **Internal assistants:** HR, IT and operations answers checked against the company's own procedures.

What a business would get: fewer statements it is liable for, an audit trail for every sentence an agent sent, model spend that does not grow with every re-check, and coverage across the languages its customers use.

4 What is proven and what is next

Proven: news articles drawing on sources in fifteen languages besides English, in production, under a pre-registered evaluation with independent labels. Not yet tested: company documents. Moving to them means rules for units and scale, for figures derived by arithmetic, and for tables, and then the same pre-registered test against the company's own standard of what counts as an error. The evaluation method transfers unchanged; it is how a business would know the layer works on its own documents before it relies on it.

Read the paper · **PDF** · **alec@bushwickdaily.com**

Sources

1. McKinsey & Company, *The state of AI in 2026: On the road to ROI*, 25 August 2026 (survey of 1,719 participants, May–June 2026).
2. Gartner, "Gartner predicts over 40% of agentic AI projects will be canceled by end of 2027," press release, 25 June 2025.
3. *Moffatt v. Air Canada*, 2024 BCCRT 149 (Civil Resolution Tribunal of British Columbia).
4. B. Edwards, "Company apologizes after AI support agent invents policy that causes user uproar," *Ars Technica*, 17 April 2025.
5. Associated Press, "Deloitte to partially refund Australian government for report with apparent AI-generated errors," 7 October 2025.

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